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A Sustainable Travel Guide to Viet Nam

A sustainable travel guide to
V I E T
N A M
N O W
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WWhhaatt iiss ssuussttaaaiinnaabbllee ttoouurriissmm??
The growing need for sustainable travel stems from
tourism?s untamed growth overthe past few decades.
Even without intending to, largenumbers of travellers quite
often bring unwanted side effects as their travel partners.
This growing awareness about the side effects of tourism
has given birth to more conscientious types of tourism. The
goal is to ensure visitors as well as their host communities
will be able to enjoy and benefit from tourism attractions
now and in the future.
3 PILLARS OF SUSTAINABLE TOURISM:
| 11 | | 22 | | 33 | |
| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
| PPEEOOPPLLEE | | PPLLAANNEETT | PPRROOFFIITT |
| Local | | Nature | | Economic |
| communities | and environment | | sustainability |
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SUSTAINABLE
HOTSPOTS
Cao Bang
Ba Be
A mountain town that
The largest natural lake once served as Ho Chi
in Vietnam, perfect for Minh?s hide out
animal lovers
Ninh Binh
Limestone karsts, ancient
pagodas, and cave town
by paddle boat
Pu Luong
Phong Nha
Cascading rice
Caves, caves and
terraces and ethenic
more caves in

minority villages
Phong Nha - Ke
Bang National Park
Dak Lak
Home of Vietnamese
coffee, water fall and
Yok Don national park
Quy Nhon
A fishing town with
beautiful beaches
and laid back vibes
Cai Be
A colourful river town Con Dao
where local life still
plays out on the river An archipelago of 15
islets with beautiful
reefs and parks
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5 ideas for
sustainable holidays
Create a positive impact in the places you go
by following these tips.

Support ethical tours - All across 1 2
1 Vietnam you'll find responsible tour
providers who offer interesting
experiences for travellers. Many
also give back to the community
by creating income for locals.

Book a homestay - Homestays
2 provide close-up encounters with
local culture. Vietnamese homestay
hosts are incredibly generous and 5
will happily organise unforgettable
tours and workshops for you.

Buy sustainable souvenirs -
3 Vietnam will give you many
chances to buy beautiful goods
that also support local artisans and
craftsmen. Lacquerware, ceramics,
and textiles are excellent

3
take-home mementos.

Help preserve culture - Did you
4 know Vietnam has hundreds of
craft villages? Touring these
traditional craft villages is a great
way to see Vietnam's countryside
and contribute to the preservation
of culture.

4
Visit lesser-known locations -
5 Vietnam has many islands, frontier

towns and nature reserves that are relatively unknown but worth seeing. Going to new destinations reduces pressure on high-profile attractions.

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Can Tho

Sustainable stays

Vietnam presents responsible travellers with countless options to connect with the country's nature, culture and people, in a way that creates a positive impact. You may be surprised to know that there are eco-friendly, sustainable places to holiday sprinkled up and down the country.

Vietnam's homestays are amazing value for money, and they also offer the chance to make friends with your host family, see local life, and support communities in Vietnam's remote and rural areas.

Vietnamese homestay hosts are incredibly generous and will happily organise unforgettable tours, sumptuous meals, and insightful workshops for you.

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Sustainable activities

Ethnic culture

Vietnam is home to 54 ethnic groups. Get to know them by visiting our ethnology museums, spending time in ethnic homestays and villages, and learning about ethnic crafts and traditions.

Smart souvenirs

Lovely lacquerware, ceramics, and textiles are excellent take-home mementos. You can help preserve Vietnamese culture by buying your souvenirs from local artisans and craftsmen.

Eco-tours

Vietnam has many eco-friendly tours that highlight nature and culture. Try a coffee farm tour in Da Lat, a paddleboat tour along a river in Ninh Binh, or an ethical elephant tour in Dak Lak.

WHERE TO START

Find a list of eco-tours, sustainable lodgings, and trip ideas on our 'Green Travel' page at vietnam.travel/sustainability

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Culture & Etiquette

Show your respect for the Vietnamese way of life by following these simple tips.

ALTAR WORSHIP

Family altars are sacred spaces. Be careful not to block or leave things in front of an altar.

DRESS CODE

Most Vietnamese are modest dressers.

Always cover up when visiting religious sites.

SAVING FACE

As a general rule, keep your cool, and avoid loud arguments and public displays of affection.

EASY PHRASES

“Xin chào” is the Vietnamese way to say “hello”, and “cám ơn” is how we say “thank you”.

TAKING PHOTOS

Many Vietnamese like to have their picture taken, but always ask for permission first.

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